

JAMES MACMILLAN

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

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LOCATION

Midlands, UK.

AVAILABILITY

1 MONTH

Cover Letter

Hey, I'm James, a Senior Software Engineer based in the Midlands, and I appreciate you taking the time to check out my CV.

I'm currently seeking full-time remote opportunities as a Senior Developer. With over 10 years of commercial web development experience and more than 5 years building cross-platform mobile applications, I bring a deep and well-rounded skill set to any team.

Over the past two years, I have built and operated multiple production applications across both AWS and GCP, gaining solid cross-cloud experience in real-world environments.

My preferred stack includes Node.js or .NET Core on the backend, paired with React and Tailwind on the frontend. That said, I've worked extensively across a broad range of frontend and server-side technologies, and I'm quick to adapt where needed.

I started building for the web at age 12, growing my skills alongside the evolution of the web itself, from desktop to mobile and beyond. Today, I specialise in full-stack development within the JavaScript ecosystem, but I also bring experience in a wide range of team environments, workflows, and technical architectures.

I'd be a strong addition to any dev team looking for a seasoned, pragmatic engineer with a passion for clean code, great UX, and effective collaboration.

Thanks again for your time,

James Macmillan

EXPERIENCE

Where I've Worked

I'm a friendly and passionate Full Stack Developer with a strong background in Agile delivery, design, UX/UI, and application architecture. I love working across the full stack; from front-end and mobile apps to cloud-native serverless apis and data stores. I have a particular focus on building robust hybrid mobile and progressive web apps.

Over the years, I've worked closely with teams of all experience levels, helping to bring ideas to life and solve tricky business problems with practical, well-designed solutions. I'm at my best when I'm collaborating with others who love technology as much as I do, and when we're building something meaningful, together.

01 Mar 2023 - Present

Songtradr

Ingesting the world's music one release at a time.



I joined the Media Delivery and Ingestion team, where I worked on building and maintaining large-scale, serverless applications that handled the ingestion, processing, and global distribution of music and its metadata.

I contributed to re-platforming key parts of the output pipeline, including pricing logic and global availability handling, and helped implement a scalable document store to support responsive release ingestion.

The role gave me deep exposure to fast-paced, pragmatic development using XP practices and TDD.

The team focused on using the right tool for the job, delivering robust, high-performance solutions while cutting unnecessary complexity and waste.

We made it a priority to empower business users with fast, reliable access to the data they needed, supporting both internal goals and growing client demands.

02 Jul 2020 - Feb 2023

Engineius

Overhauling, updating, and improving Mobile and Web apps.



03 Nov 2017 - Jan 2020

Packt

Shipping the mobile app for the Subscription platform and going Serverless.



04 Sep 2012 - Oct 2017

Severn Trent

Delivering web and mobile apps to drive the business forward.



What I Work With

My favourite stack these days is Node.js running on Lambdas or containers, backed by a solid RDS and object storage setup. On the front end, I enjoy working with React (or similar component-based frameworks), styled with Tailwind and bundled up nicely. For mobile, I've been a long-time fan of Ionic but I'm open to exploring other frameworks like React Native or Flutter, depending on the project requirements.

That said, I've worked across a range of setups; from traditional stacks with Node and .NET Core APIs deployed on AWS (via containers, EC2s, and Lambdas), to static and server-side rendered sites. Recently I've enjoyed working on cloud-native applications in AWS and GCP, leveraging the power of serverless architectures and microservices to build scalable and efficient systems.

 HTML 5

 CSS 3

 Javascript

 NodeJS

 .net core

 AWS

 GCP

 C#

 Serverless

 AWS Lambda

 Stencil JS

 Capacitor

 Ionic

 iOS

 Android

 Webpack

 SQLite

 SQL Server

 MySQL

 Photoshop

 Sketch

 git

 Angular

 Typescript

 React

 Tailwind

Where I Studied

Coventry University

Sep 2009 - Jun 2012

BSc Computer Science G400, 2.1 with Honors

Caroline Chisholm School

Sep 2002 - Jun 2009

3 A Levels Including Computing

11 GCSEs

Things I've Built

Portal Architecture

Updated the Web Portal's architecture to split front end and api.



The customer facing web portal was serving via. an old Angular .net core template's architecture. Each client route returned an angular app as a page.

In this project I extracted the front end Angular apps into their own project, bootstrapped webpack and switched all routing to the angular front end.

This involved overhauling routing, the webpack build, and the angular project as a whole.

As a part of this project I also identified that the vendor bundle had been misconfigured, serving node_module dependencies twice.

Fixing this, implementing Lazy Loaded routing and separating the front end server from the back-end server resulted in significant performance improvements.

This also had a significant impact on development turnover, prior to these changes the rebuild cycle was well over a minute on most developer's machines.

Mobile App

Bringing a third party development in house

Engineius originally outsourced their app development as is common in early startup phase.

This project involved bringing the functioning production app development in house and up to a long term maintainable standard.

My initial work here was to take stock, and roughly plan the necessary changes to ensure long term maintenance.

There was also a looming deadline of an iOS upgrade deprecating the old Web View.

I started by implementing some node best practices; dependency pinning, auto formatting & linting with CI layer build checks.

I then upgraded the underlying frameworks to their latest stable versions, this included bringing Nativecscript to v7+ and Angular to 12+.

As these were significant major version releases there was lots of in depth analysis and retest work along with the development.

Once this work was complete and functioning I then focused on outstanding production app issues.

In particular there were multiple memory leaks, performance drags and the app's styling had not been completed or branded.